

TEACH

SUPPORTS TERTIARY WHAT

FOR WHY-HOW · HOW-WHY

The WIP Limit Practice

A hard cap on open threads that forces completion before new exploration. **Finishing becomes the price of starting**, which is the only currency this drain reliably responds to.

THE DRAIN

Curiosity opens threads; momentum closes them. For tertiary WHAT profiles the opening is energizing and the closing is not, so open threads accumulate, each one nearly done, none of them shipped, all of them consuming background attention.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The practice is a single rule: no more than three open threads, and a new one cannot open until one closes or is parked, formally and in writing. The rule converts your genuine appetite for the new into the engine that drives completion of the old.

The practice

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| 1 | Count | List every open thread honestly. The number is usually a surprise. |
| 2 | Cap | Three. Not five. The discomfort of three is the mechanism. |
| 3 | Close or park to open | A new thread requires a finished one or a formally parked one. |
| 4 | Park in writing | Parked means logged with a one-line state, so it can be resumed or retired. |
| 5 | Review the lot monthly | Parked items either get a slot, or get retired on purpose. |

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 Do the first count with a witness.** Accountability at the start; the initial cut from twelve to three is the hard part.
- 2 Choose the three by receiver value.** Not by interestingness. Whose waiting is most expensive?
- 3 Make the parking lot honest.** A park with no written state is just a dropped thread with better branding.
- 4 Let the cap create the pressure.** When something new excites you, that energy now has one outlet: finish something.

WHAT IT WON'T DO

A WIP limit cannot make finishing energizing, and the cap will chafe, that is it working. It also needs honest thread-counting; splitting one project into "sub-threads" to dodge the cap is a known failure mode. Count like an auditor.

IN THE KIT

Thread inventory sheet

Parking lot template

Monthly review card

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 11 Good-Enough Threshold · **Tool 17** The Momentum Board · **Tool 13** Decision Deadline Ritual